

Assessing your well-being and battery charge

Just like a battery in a device, our body and mind also have a limited energy capacity that needs to be monitored regularly so we can function optimally in our daily lives.

How can we assess our “battery” level?

At some point in our lives, we have all experienced the feeling of running on empty. Equally, we have experienced feeling fully energized and full of energy. How full is your well-being battery charge right now?

A simple method from Andrew Hamilton

Andrew Hamilton, a sports science writer and researcher, asks athletes to take a six-question quiz each morning by rating the following statements on a scale from 1 (strongly disagree) to 5 (strongly agree), and then adding up the total score.

	I slept really well last night.	1	2	3	4	5
	I feel vigorous and energetic.	1	2	3	4	5
	I have very little muscle soreness.	1	2	3	4	5
...	... and 3 other questions.	1	2	3	4	5



When an athlete's score drops below 20, it is recommended to take a recovery day or switch to lighter (“taper”) workouts until their battery is sufficiently recharged.

Recovery goes beyond the physical, it is holistic.

We can apply a similar approach to our own well-being by paying equal attention to five dimensions of recovery:



Exercise: Assessing your battery level

1

We expanded on Hamilton's quiz to help you assess and build awareness of your level of recovery.

2

Take a moment to reflect on which of the following statements are true for you, and make sure to note if certain categories are particularly strong or weak.

3

After you have taken a moment to reflect, compare how many statements you have marked as true with the guidance below on what to focus on for this course.



Self-Assessment Statements

For each statement, indicate how true it is for you right now.

1 = Strongly disagree | 2 = Disagree | 3 = Neutral | 4 = Agree | 5 = Strongly agree



I slept very well last night.

1 2 3 4 5



I have clear, purposeful intentions for the day.

1 2 3 4 5



I am looking forward to the day's activities.

1 2 3 4 5



I am optimistic about my future.

1 2 3 4 5



I feel vigorous and energetic.

1 2 3 4 5



My diet is healthy and well-balanced.

1 2 3 4 5



I am experiencing very little fatigue or burnout.

1 2 3 4 5



I can focus on the things that matter most.

1 2 3 4 5



I feel connected to the important people in my life.

1 2 3 4 5



What's next?

After completing the assessment, compare how many statements you marked as true with the next section to see which areas you can focus on for this course.

Battery Score

Your Battery Score gives you a snapshot of your current well-being and energy level. Use the guidance below to understand what your score means and where to focus as you move through this course.



Your battery is empty

Regularly charging your battery — and maintaining its charge — would benefit all areas of your life.

Focus areas in this course:



How to tap into your sources of well-being: physical, mental & emotional, social, and spiritual



Specific practices that stand out to you and are worth turning into habits



The impact a “full battery” could have on your life



Your battery charge is running low and needs attention

You have some well-being charge left, but it would be better to have more. Regularly charging your battery — and maintaining its charge — would benefit all areas of your life.

Focus areas in this course:



How to tap into your sources of well-being: physical, mental & emotional, social, and spiritual



Specific practices that stand out to you and are worth turning into habits



The impact a “full battery” could have on your life



You would benefit from extra charge to your battery

Your well-being battery is charged, but take a look — is there one category where you scored lower than others? Research shows we need a balance of all four areas for optimal well-being. Maintaining this level of well-being is real work, but it is worth it!

Focus areas in this course:



How to tap into your sources of well-being: physical, mental & emotional, social, and spiritual



Specific practices that stand out to you and are worth turning into habits



The impact a “full battery” could have on your life



Your battery is fully charged

Right now, you are moving through life with a fully charged battery — which is great! You are starting from a good place, but there are times when you might find it difficult to maintain this level.

Keep it up by:



Continuing the practices that work for you



Staying mindful of all four areas of well-being



Checking in regularly to maintain your energy level

What are the ingredients of well-being?

Your well-being battery is fueled by four sources: physical, mental & emotional, social, and spiritual.

However, in our daily lives, we often prioritize just one or two sources. To ensure your well-being is truly at its best, combine all four.

Think about which source offers the biggest opportunity to charge your battery, and explore the key ingredients of that source below.



Physical

A healthy and energetic body provides the foundation for you to live life to the fullest.

Sleep	+
Exercise	+
Nutrition	+



Mental and Emotional

A clear and calm mind and stable emotions help you stay focused, resilient, and productive.

Hobbies	+
Meditation	+
Focus	+
Self-reflection	+



Spiritual

A sense of meaning, purpose, and connection to something greater provides direction and inner peace in your life.

Vocational calling / life purpose	+
Spiritual connection	+



Social

Positive and supportive relationships with people around you strengthen your well-being overall.

Relationships	+
Role in the community	+



Principles for putting this into practice

No matter which source of well-being you want to prioritize or the specific behaviors you want to improve, there are four big ideas that will help you maximize your efforts.

01

Be specific and focused in your actions.

Set clear and concrete behaviors rather than vague goals.



MY PLAN

- ✓ Be specific
- ✓ Take action
- ✓ Stay consistent

02

Don't rely on just one big moment to energize yourself.

Instead, do small things throughout the day to maintain your energy.



Small Steps
Big Change

03

Tiny behaviors lead to sustainable change.

Small, consistent behaviors compound over time and create lasting impact.



BETTER HABITS
BRIGHTER DAYS
A HEALTHIER YOU

04

Small and frequent is best.

Make it a regular part of your routine, even in small doses, to see real results.



A LITTLE PROGRESS EVERY DAY

05

Identify some existing cues that prompt healthy behaviors.

Use triggers in your environment to make healthy choices easier and more automatic.



Same Cue
Better Choice

06

Find others who can support you, offer feedback, and share ideas with you.

Surround yourself with people who encourage your growth.



How can you stay balanced?

01

Like a rechargeable battery, you want to avoid the moment when your well-being level is almost empty and the warning light goes on. The inverted U is a slippery slope, and the further away you get from the top, the harder it is to return.

02

That said, it is not easy to keep your well-being permanently at its maximum—life certainly does not work that way! You will have times where you experience too much stress or not enough. The key is to stay as balanced as you can, so you avoid depleting your physical, mental, social, or spiritual energy through either boredom or burnout.



Did you know?

The body has a “budget.” According to Dr. Lisa Feldman Barrett, the body budget indicates how much energy is stored in your batteries, and how you use your energy. Your brain manages how much energy gets in or out of your body. You can manage your body budget in deficit for a while, but at some point, it will “go bankrupt” if the budget is not replenished. Recovery, therefore, is key!



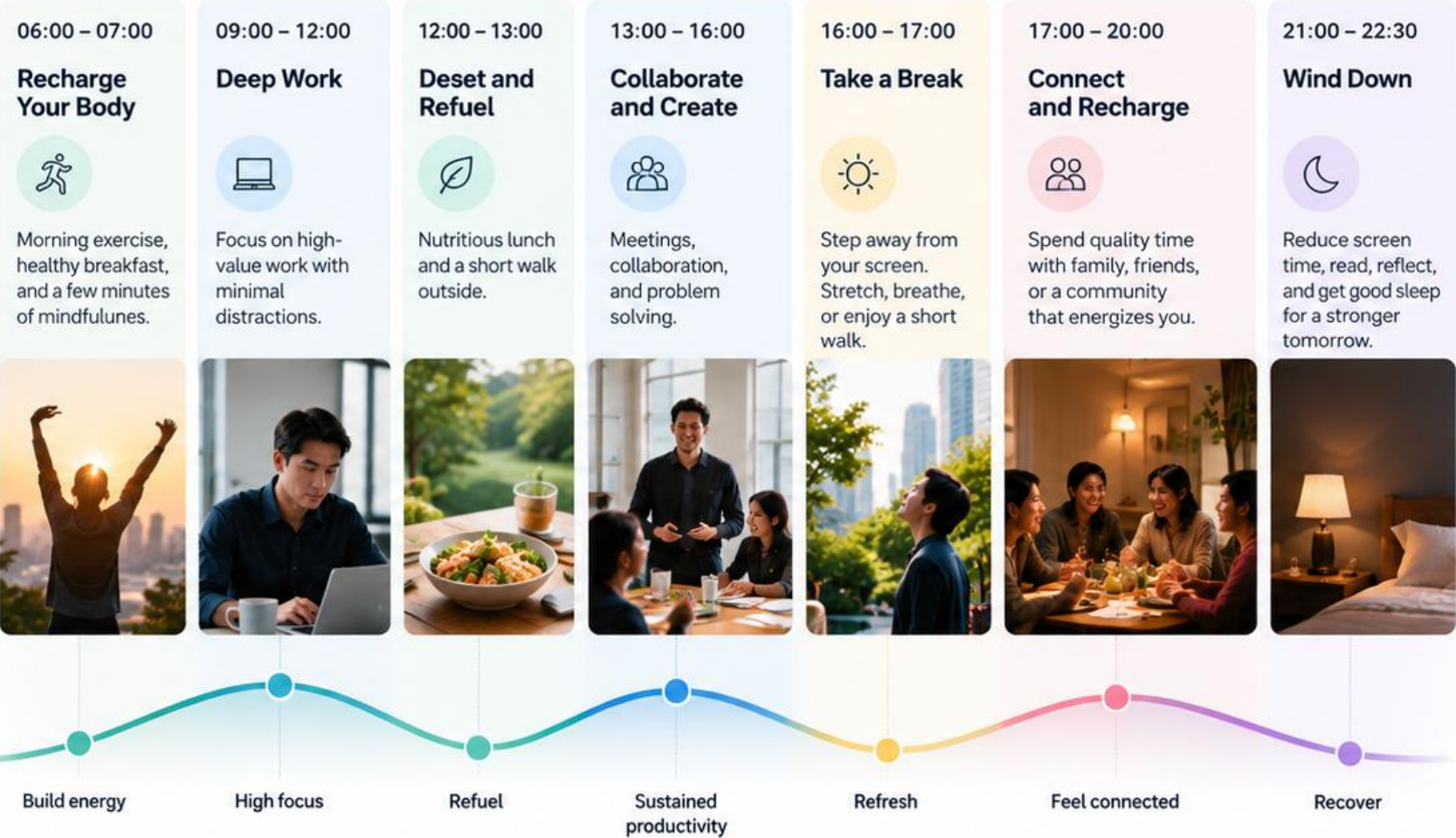
What is the relationship between well-being and recovery?

Recovery is critical to our well-being. Our performance and ability to access a state of learning are dependent on our battery charge. With adequate recovery and charged batteries, we can better manage stress and maintain focus—helping us recover more effectively and prevent our energy from draining too quickly.



The importance of recovery

Below is an example of a busy human who is, nonetheless, living a balanced day. It is based on a number of real practices shared by experts in well-being. You will see that the goal is not intensity, but rather weaving in moments of recovery throughout your day.



Key Takeaway

 Recovery is not a break from productivity—it fuels it.

 Small, consistent moments of recovery make a big difference.

 A balanced day leads to higher energy, better focus, and a healthier, happier life.

A Balanced Day with Recovery in Mind

Here is an example of a busy human who is, nonetheless, living a balanced day. It is based on real practices shared by experts in well-being. The goal is not intensity, but rather weaving moments of recovery throughout your day.

*Small moments of recovery
create a big difference.*



06:00 – 07:00

Mindful Wake Up

Resist the urge to reach for your phone. Spend at least 20 minutes on a non-work morning routine.



07:00 – 09:00

Morning Routine

Bring some intention setting and movement into every morning. For example, take a few minutes to stretch, do light exercise, and set your intention for the day ahead.



09:00 – 12:00

Deep Work

Focus on high-value work with minimal distractions.



12:00 – 13:00

Reset and Refuel

Have a nutritious lunch and take a short walk outside.



13:00 – 16:00

Collaborate and Create

Meetings, collaboration, and problem solving.



Morning

Midday



16:00 – 17:00

Take a Break

Step away from your screen. Stretch, breathe, or enjoy a short walk.



17:00 – 20:00

Connect and Recharge

Spend quality time with family, friends, or a community that energizes you.



21:00 – 21:30

Daily Appreciation

Send a quick text, email, or call to appreciate someone who matters to you.



21:30 – 22:00

Wind Down

Reduce screen time, read, reflect, and get good sleep for a stronger tomorrow.



During the Day

Movement While Working

Be active at your desk or walk during calls and meetings when possible.



Afternoon

Evening

Throughout the Day